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SUP-100732

???

The ship sways gently in the waves.

It is set for a new world, and there's no turning back.

Sophia: ...

She hasn't spoken a word since they sailed.

The situation is final and the board is set, there's nothing for her to do but to stay silent.

Manus Believer I: Ms. Sophia.

Manus Believer I: Is the Guiding One really not coming with us? She ...

Sophia: ...

She doesn't answer, absentmindedly caressing the tiny idol.

She still remembers the moment she received it.

Sophia: Are you saying ...

Arcana: Fret not, my child.

Arcana: You heard me true.

Arcana: I shall die today.

Sonetto: Timekeeper, location α is ready for the ritual!

Lilya: Location β, ready!

Regulus: Mr. APPLe and I are ready!

Vertin: Good!

This is not a preparation for an attack. At least not for an attack here.

Vertin: Requesting to use the advanced arcane skill "Aferoj Around," No. 000262603100008,

Vertin: to teleport a top priority threat to the Parmenides Base!

The glow of the ritual envelops Arcana.

Arcana: Oh?

Lilya: Loosen up and enjoy the ride.

Lilya: Goodbye.

The Parmenides Base, Zeno

Operator I: Launch sequence initiated. Starting countdown. 30, 29, 28 ...

Observer I: The target has not reached the designated location. I repeat, the target has ...

Operator I: 15, 14, 13 ...

Observer I: Large-scale arcane ritual detected. "Aferoj Around," verified. Life signal detected. Target is in position. Initiating detonation ...

Operator I: 6, 5, 4, 3, 2 ...

Operator I: 1!

Operator I: Vacuum bomb detonated.

Observer I: No arcane energy detected. No life signal detected.

Observer I: Target eliminated. I repeat. The target has been eliminated.

Operator I: We did it? We actually did it!

Operator I: Admiral, Hans, we made up for what we didn't do in '99.

Observer I: Did we win?

Admiral Igor: It's too early to celebrate.

Admiral Igor: But history will remember this moment and honor all that was lost in this long battle.

Operator I: Wait. Hans!

Operator I: You hear that? In your headphones.

Everyone can hear it.

A grating static.

Observer I: ...

Observer I: A-Admiral, we might have a life signal, but there's too much interference.

Admiral Igor: Give me that.

The plan was made with little time to spare, and the location chosen for the observation room is far from ideal.

But soon enough, the strange sound in the room subsides.

Admiral Igor: ...

Admiral Igor: ...

Admiral Igor: No, it's nothing. There is no sign of life.

Admiral Igor: It was the wind.

Crowd: ...

Operator I: So, that means ...

We did it, everyone.

Operator I: A triumphant victory! A salute to you, admiral, and to the Timekeeper!

Observer I: Our efforts for peace have prevailed, and we have emerged victorious. Let us forever remember this day for its greatness!

Crowd: Glory to all who fought for this moment!

Crowd: We did it!

The observation room erupts in triumph.

Arcana, deceased.

TO BE CONTINUED...